COMPLAINTAI-BANK

BANKING FEES, CHARGES AND INTEREST POLICY

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Policy Category: Banking Fees, Charges and Interest

1. Purpose

Objectives

This policy establishes the principles and procedures for identifying, explaining, applying, reviewing, collecting, adjusting, and refunding banking fees, service charges, interest, and other transaction-related costs. It sets expectations for clear disclosure, accurate calculation, consistent billing, and fair investigation of customer questions.

The policy is intended to help customers understand why a charge may apply, when interest may accrue, how amounts are reflected in account or card records, and how to raise a concern about an amount they believe is incorrect. It also requires staff and automated systems to distinguish confirmed product terms from general explanations.

No particular amount, rate, waiver, billing date, grace period, or fee entitlement should be presented as universal. The applicable product terms, fee schedule, transaction details, and customer-specific conditions must be checked before a definitive answer is given.

2. Scope

Products and cost types covered

This policy applies to account maintenance charges, minimum-balance fees, statement and document fees, transfers and remittances, card issuance and replacement, cash withdrawals, foreign-currency transactions, credit-card interest, cash-advance costs, late-payment charges, overdue amounts, service requests, and other fees or costs disclosed for a banking product or transaction.

It covers fee and interest disclosure, calculations and posting, statement review, changes to charges, waivers and exemptions, disputed charges, corrections and refunds, customer communication, and complaint records. The exact fee or rate applicable to a transaction depends on the relevant product, channel, amount, currency, date, and contractual conditions.

This policy provides a general framework. Where a specific product agreement, current schedule of charges, statement, or other applicable term establishes a more specific requirement, that source must be checked and applied.

3. Definitions

Key terms

Fee or Service Charge: An amount charged for a product, service, transaction, event, or account condition in accordance with the applicable terms.

Interest: A financing or balance-related amount calculated under the terms applicable to a credit facility or other interest-bearing product.

Annual Fee: A recurring card or service charge that may apply for a stated period under the relevant product terms.

Minimum-Balance Charge: A fee that may apply when an account does not meet a stated balance condition, if provided for by the relevant terms.

Cash Advance: A credit-card transaction treated as cash borrowing or a similar cash-equivalent transaction under the applicable card agreement.

Foreign-Currency Conversion: The process of converting a transaction amount from one currency to another using the applicable conversion method and timing.

Grace Period: A period during which interest may not be charged on eligible purchases if the conditions specified in the relevant credit agreement are satisfied.

Minimum Payment: The minimum amount required to be paid by the due date under the applicable credit-card agreement and statement.

Waiver: An approved exemption from a charge, or a reduction or reversal of a charge, under an applicable rule or authorized decision.

Fee Dispute: A request to explain or review a fee, charge, interest amount, rate, or related calculation that a customer believes may be incorrect.

Schedule of Charges: The applicable document or disclosure setting out the fees and charges for a product, service, or transaction.

4. Disclosure Before a Service or Transaction

4.1 Clear fee information

Where a fee or rate is applicable and the information is available before a customer confirms a service or transaction, the relevant amount, rate, basis, or method should be disclosed through the approved channel. Disclosure should be clear enough for the customer to understand what the charge relates to and which conditions may affect it.

Depending on the service, information may include a fixed charge, percentage-based fee, minimum or maximum charge, recurring frequency, interest rate, conversion method, applicable tax, or the event that triggers the charge. If a figure depends on transaction details, the customer should be shown the calculated amount where the service supports that calculation.

A general summary must not replace a more specific disclosure required by the applicable product terms. Where a fee cannot be confirmed before processing, the customer should be directed to the relevant terms or informed of the uncertainty rather than given an unsupported amount.

4.2 Customer review and confirmation

Customers should review displayed fees, exchange-rate information, credit terms, and other disclosed costs before confirming a service. The customer should be able to distinguish the amount being transferred or spent from a separate service charge or conversion cost where the channel displays them separately.

Where the service requires explicit acceptance of a fee or updated term, the acceptance must be collected through the approved process and recorded where required. A record of a customer having submitted a transaction should not be treated as proof of a separate acceptance unless the applicable process supports that conclusion.

4.3 Missing or unclear disclosure

If a customer cannot locate the applicable fee or rate, the service team should identify the product, transaction type, channel, date, and relevant schedule before providing an explanation. If the available materials do not establish the charge, the team must not infer an amount from a different product or transaction.

Where a fee appears to have been applied without the expected disclosure, the matter should be recorded for review. The outcome must depend on the applicable terms, the transaction evidence, and any relevant disclosure requirements.

5. Types of Fees and Charges

5.1 Account and maintenance fees

Account-related charges may include maintenance, minimum-balance, statement, document, account service, or other fees specified in the account terms. Whether a charge applies may depend on the account type, selected package, balance conditions, transaction activity, customer category, or an approved exemption.

A fee associated with one account type must not automatically be applied to another. When explaining an account charge, the reviewer should verify the account product and applicable conditions for the period in which the charge was assessed.

5.2 Transaction and transfer charges

Transfer and payment charges may vary by payment route, channel, amount, currency, destination, processing option, or recipient arrangement. A transaction may also be subject to a separate currency-conversion cost or a charge imposed under the applicable payment arrangement.

The customer should be given an explanation of each identifiable charge reflected in the relevant transaction or statement. Where the final cost differs from a pre-transaction estimate, the reason should be checked against the applied terms, transaction records, currency conversion, and any disclosed third-party or intermediary charges.

5.3 Card-related fees

Card fees may include issuance, annual or periodic fees, replacement, expedited delivery, cash advances, ATM usage, foreign-currency purchases, or other card-service charges. Availability and amounts vary by card product and the relevant fee schedule.

An explanation of a card fee should identify the transaction or service that triggered it, the card product, the applicable period, and the relevant rate or amount. A charge should not be described as a penalty or interest unless the applicable terms identify it as such.

5.4 Other charges and taxes

Other charges may apply where explicitly provided for by the applicable service terms, including costs associated with special requests, additional services, or certain transaction events. Any applicable tax should be explained according to the relevant disclosure and calculation.

A customer-facing response must not invent a tax rate, fee category, or third-party deduction. Where the source materials do not establish the basis or amount, the issue should be referred for verification.

6. Interest and Credit-Related Costs

6.1 Applicable interest terms

Interest may apply to eligible outstanding balances or transactions under the terms of a credit facility or other interest-bearing product. The rate, calculation basis, accrual start date, posting frequency, and conditions for applying interest must be taken from the applicable product agreement and current disclosures.

Interest rules may differ between retail purchases, cash advances, balance transfers, overdue amounts, or other balance categories. A single rate or calculation method must not be assumed to apply to every category unless the agreement expressly establishes that result.

6.2 Grace periods and eligible purchases

A credit product may provide a grace period for eligible purchases when the customer satisfies the conditions stated in the agreement, such as paying the required balance by the due date. Eligibility, duration, and the effect of carrying an unpaid balance must be determined from the applicable terms.

Customers should not be told that all transactions are interest-free merely because a product advertises a grace period. Cash advances, certain transfers, fees, or other balance types may be treated differently under the agreement.

6.3 Cash advances and similar transactions

A cash advance or a transaction treated as a cash equivalent may have separate fees and interest treatment. The applicable fee, accrual method, and repayment allocation must be checked before explaining the cost.

Where the customer questions a cash-advance cost, the review should identify the transaction classification, date, amount, fee entry, interest entry, and relevant agreement provisions. A purchase transaction should not be reclassified as a cash advance without supporting transaction information.

6.4 Interest calculation enquiries

An interest calculation enquiry should be assessed using the relevant balance, rate, date range, transaction postings, payments, adjustments, and calculation method specified by the applicable agreement. If interest is calculated daily or uses a periodic balance method, the explanation must follow the actual documented method.

The reviewer should distinguish the displayed annual rate from the amount charged in a particular statement period. A customer must not be given a simplified calculation as the definitive result if the agreement uses a more specific method or includes transaction-level timing and allocation rules.

7. Credit Card Repayments, Minimum Payments and Overdue Amounts

7.1 Statement balance and due date

The statement should be reviewed to identify the balance, minimum payment, payment due date, posted transactions, fees, interest, and any adjustments. The amount required for a particular billing cycle must be taken from the applicable statement and agreement.

Customers should allow for the processing method and timing of a payment when making a payment close to the due date. A payment instruction submitted by the customer should not be treated as credited to the account until the relevant account record confirms the posting or status.

7.2 Minimum payment and payment allocation

The minimum payment and the way payments are allocated between balances, fees, interest, and principal are governed by the applicable credit agreement. A customer who pays the minimum amount may still incur interest or retain an outstanding balance, depending on the agreement and account status.

When explaining how a payment affected the balance, the reviewer should verify the payment date, amount, posting date, balance categories, and applicable allocation method. It should not be assumed that a payment was applied to a particular transaction or balance without checking the records.

7.3 Late payment and overdue charges

Late-payment charges, default-related interest, or other overdue costs may apply when stated conditions are met under the applicable agreement. The relevant due date, payment status, grace or remedy provisions, and any permitted waiver must be reviewed before confirming the charge.

If a customer made a payment before the stated due date but the account reflects a late charge, the case should examine payment initiation, receipt, posting, channel processing, and the terms defining when payment is considered received. The charge should not be upheld or reversed solely on an assumption about timing.

7.4 Repayment difficulty

Customers who report difficulty meeting a payment should be directed to the authorized support or assistance process available for the product. Any repayment arrangement, rescheduling, waiver, or other accommodation must be confirmed by an authorized decision and must not be promised by an automated response.

A complaint about an interest or late charge does not, by itself, amend the agreement or suspend payment obligations. The customer should receive accurate information about the status of the enquiry and any confirmed action.

8. Foreign-Currency Conversion and International Costs

8.1 Conversion and applied rate

For a foreign-currency transaction, the final amount may depend on the original transaction currency, settlement currency, conversion method, conversion timing, and any fee specified by the applicable terms. The rate observed at the point of purchase may differ from the rate used when the transaction is processed or settled.

A rate enquiry should identify the transaction date, original currency and amount, posted amount, transaction channel, and any separately displayed fee. The review should use the applicable transaction records rather than substitute an unrelated market rate.

8.2 International transfer deductions

International payments may include a transfer fee, conversion cost, or permitted deductions associated with the payment route or receiving arrangement. The amount received by the beneficiary may differ from the amount sent depending on the selected service and applicable terms.

Where a customer reports an unexpected difference, the reviewer should separate the sender-side debit, disclosed service fee, currency conversion, and any identifiable downstream deduction. A specific deduction should not be attributed to an outside party unless supported by the available records.

8.3 Disclosure and customer explanation

Where conversion information is displayed before authorization, the customer should be advised to review the amount, currency, rate, and applicable fee. If the final posted result differs, the explanation should identify which transaction stage and disclosed method account for the difference, where that can be established.

If the available records do not reveal the applied rate or the reason for a difference, the question should remain open for verification rather than being answered using a guessed exchange rate or fee.

9. Fee Changes, Waivers and Exemptions

9.1 Changes to fees and rates

Changes to fees, rates, or product conditions should be made and communicated according to the applicable agreement, disclosure obligations, and authorized change process. The effective period of a change should be established from the relevant notice or terms rather than inferred from the date on which a customer first notices it.

When a customer questions a changed fee, the review should compare the prior and current terms, the date of the transaction or billing event, any required notice, and the product conditions applicable at that time.

9.2 Waivers and exemptions

A waiver or exemption may apply only where supported by product terms, a documented promotion, a customer-specific arrangement, or an authorized decision. Eligibility conditions may include a stated period, account type, balance condition, qualifying activity, or other requirement.

A previous waiver does not automatically prove continuing eligibility. The reviewer should confirm the applicable terms and period, any qualifying conditions, and whether the waiver was applied to the transaction or billing period in question.

9.3 Promotional or introductory terms

Promotional fees, introductory interest rates, and temporary exemptions should be applied only for the stated eligibility criteria and period. Any expiry date, post-promotion rate, spending requirement, or other condition must be drawn from the relevant offer or agreement.

Where a customer believes a promotion was not applied, the case should examine the offer terms, enrollment or eligibility record, transaction date, and relevant statement entries. The system must not assume a promotional benefit applies merely because the customer mentions it.

10. Fee and Interest Disputes

10.1 Grounds for review

A customer may request a review of a fee or interest amount that appears unfamiliar, duplicated, incorrectly calculated, applied to the wrong product, inconsistent with a disclosed rate, charged during a claimed exemption period, or assessed despite a timely payment or completed service cancellation.

The customer should provide the statement date, amount, description, transaction or account reference, product type, and a clear explanation of the concern. Relevant statements, confirmations, notices, and supporting records may be requested where necessary.

10.2 Investigation steps

The responsible team should identify the charge, determine the terms in force for the relevant period, verify the trigger event, and check the transaction or balance data used to calculate it. The review may include account conditions, payment posting, rate and fee tables, relevant notices, waivers, and previous adjustments.

The case record should show which facts were verified, which terms were consulted, any calculations or adjustments performed, and the reason for the outcome. Where the source does not provide enough information to verify the amount, the case should be referred to an authorized reviewer.

10.3 Resolution and correction

If an error is confirmed, the appropriate correction, reversal, interest adjustment, or refund should be processed through the authorized procedure. If the charge is found to be consistent with the applicable terms, the explanation should identify the basis for that conclusion to the extent it can be shared.

A request submitted, an investigation opened, or a provisional adjustment must not be described as a completed refund or final decision unless the relevant record confirms that status.

10.4 Escalation

If the customer disagrees with the explanation or the issue remains unresolved, the customer may use the designated complaint or escalation channel. The response should include the relevant case reference and any next step that is actually available.

An escalation must not be represented as guaranteeing a fee waiver, refund, or different decision. Any further review should follow the applicable process and preserve the previous case record.

11. Refunds, Reversals and Adjustments

11.1 Refund eligibility

A fee or interest refund may be considered where an error is established, an applicable term provides for a refund, an authorized waiver is approved, a duplicate charge is identified, or another documented basis supports an adjustment. The existence of a complaint alone does not establish that a refund is due.

The review should identify the original charge, amount, date, product, applicable rule, and any previous correction. Where the requested amount includes multiple charges, each charge should be assessed separately when the applicable basis differs.

11.2 Processing and posting

An approved refund or adjustment must be processed through the authorized accounting or servicing procedure. The record should distinguish between approved, initiated, pending, posted, rejected, or completed status, as supported by the relevant system.

The customer should be informed of the confirmed amount and expected processing information only where available. No fixed processing period should be invented where the applicable process does not establish one.

11.3 Reconciliation and duplicate adjustment prevention

Before applying an adjustment, the responsible team should check whether the same charge has already been refunded, reversed, credited, or included in a previous adjustment. This reduces the risk of duplicate credits and inconsistent account records.

If a duplicate refund or incorrect adjustment is found, the case should be referred for review under the applicable accounting and correction controls. Any recovery or offset must follow the relevant terms and authorized procedures.

12. Statements, Notices and Customer Records

12.1 Statement review

Statements and transaction histories should identify relevant charges and interest entries in a way consistent with the available product format. Customers should review these records and raise questions promptly when a charge is unfamiliar or appears incorrect.

The review should consider the billing period, posting date, description, amount, related transaction, and any previous adjustment. A description on a statement may be abbreviated; when it is unclear, the service team should use the underlying record to identify the charge.

12.2 Notices and rate information

Where a fee, rate, or term change requires notice, the notice should be handled through the applicable communication procedure. The relevant version, date, product, and change should be identifiable from the supporting record.

If a customer says a notice was not received, the investigation may review registered contact information, delivery channel, notice records, and any applicable requirements. The absence of a customer-held copy should not by itself prove that notice was or was not delivered.

12.3 Recordkeeping

Records concerning fees, interest calculations, waivers, disputes, refunds, and customer communications should be maintained according to applicable legal, contractual, and organizational requirements. Access should be limited to authorized personnel and information should be protected against unauthorized alteration or disclosure.

Any calculation or correction should be traceable to the relevant source data and applicable terms. Sensitive authentication credentials must not be recorded as part of fee dispute notes.

13. Customer Responsibilities and Communication Standards

13.1 Customer responsibilities

Customers are expected to:

1. Review fee, rate, and other cost disclosures presented for a product or transaction.
2. Read applicable account, card, credit, and service terms where cost conditions are important to a decision.
3. Review statements and transaction history and question unclear charges with relevant details.
4. Keep contact information current where needed to receive statements and notices.
5. Retain transaction confirmations, statements, fee notices, promotion terms, and complaint references where relevant.
6. Provide accurate information when requesting a fee or interest review.
7. Avoid sharing passwords, PINs, one-time passcodes, or other authentication secrets in complaints.
8. Continue to follow applicable payment obligations unless an authorized arrangement or instruction confirms otherwise.

13.2 Communication standards

Fee explanations should be factual, specific to the customer's product and transaction, and clear about any remaining uncertainty. The response should distinguish the fee amount, the reason it applied, the relevant terms, and any available review outcome.

Staff and automated systems must not invent a fee, quote an outdated rate as current, confuse interest with a service fee, or promise a waiver before approval. When information is unavailable, the customer should be directed to an authorized source or reviewer.

14. Data Protection, Exceptions and Policy Review

14.1 Information protection

Personal, account, transaction, statement, and credit-related information should be accessed only for an authorized servicing, disclosure, verification, investigation, or complaint purpose. Access should be proportionate to role and need, and information should be protected against unauthorized access, disclosure, alteration, or loss.

Records should contain only information reasonably required for the task and be retained or disposed of according to applicable requirements. Fee and interest calculations should be stored with appropriate supporting context without exposing unnecessary personal information.

14.2 Exceptions and interpretation

Specific fees, rates, minimum-payment rules, grace periods, waivers, taxes, calculation methods, and processing times depend on the relevant product terms and disclosed schedule. If the available policy documents do not establish a particular amount or rule, it must not be invented or presented as confirmed.

Where the interpretation depends on a customer-specific agreement, promotion, or historical version of a fee schedule, the relevant source and date should be checked. Unresolved questions should be referred to the authorized team.

14.3 ComPlaintAI-Bank workflow integrity

Within ComPlaintAI-Bank, a fee or interest complaint may be categorized, recorded, and assigned to an internal queue according to the configured workflow. The system may confirm registration only after the database write succeeds.

The project must not claim that a charge has been reversed, a refund has been paid, an interest rate has been changed, or an external escalation has occurred unless an authorized connected system confirms the action. A recommended next step must be described as guidance, not as a completed transaction.

14.4 Policy review

This policy should be reviewed when product terms, fee schedules, interest calculation methods, disclosure procedures, or applicable requirements change. Specific amounts or rates should be updated only after the applicable authoritative source has been verified.

Related policies include Account Management and Banking Services Policy; Debit and Credit Card Services Policy; Fraud, Unauthorized Transactions and Disputes Policy; Fund Transfers, Remittances and Refunds Policy; Banking Fees, Charges and Interest Policy; Digital Banking and Authentication Policy; Customer Complaint Registration and Resolution Policy; and Complaint Priority, Department Routing and Data Privacy Policy.

End of Policy